

Announcements and Reminders

February 2025

FOR ELDERS

1. **2025 Memorial Preparations:** Please follow the instructions regarding preparations for the Memorial that appear in the *Shepherd* book, chapter 20, paragraphs 6-13.

2. **2025 Special Talk and Memorial:** We encourage all elders to consider whether their circumstances would allow them to serve as auxiliary pioneers during March or April. (Rom. 12:11; Heb. 13:17) Encourage publishers to invite family members, Bible students, return visits, and other acquaintances to the special talk and Memorial.

3. **How to Attack an Outline (emsv 01):** The video *How to Attack an Outline* has been made available to elders and ministerial servants in the “Event Media” section of the “Documents” tab on JW Hub. This video is a recording of a talk presented to brothers in the Bethel family. It will be discussed during the circuit overseer’s meeting with elders and ministerial servants when he visits the congregation between March and August 2025. Each elder and ministerial servant should view the video prior to the meeting.

4. **Hospitality for Visiting Speakers:** As a kind reminder, please show hospitality to visiting speakers by asking to cover their travel expenses and by offering them a meal.—Rom. 12:13.

5. **School for Kingdom Evangelizers:** There continues to be a great need for young ones to apply to attend the School for Kingdom Evangelizers. Please be alert to identify young ones who have the potential to apply to attend the school and encourage them to submit an application.

6. **Working Safely at Kingdom Halls:** Please plan any maintenance or large cleaning projects well in advance to ensure that necessary tools and safety equipment will be available. Determine any necessary measures that should be taken to eliminate or control risks, especially from falls.

7. **Ministerial Servants Younger Than 18 Years of Age:** As stated in the January 15, 2025, announcement for congregations, a baptized brother must be at least 18 years of age to be appointed as a ministerial servant. However, if a brother younger than 18 years of age has already been appointed as a ministerial servant, he can continue to serve.

8. Please note the following reminders and cautions regarding ministerial servants who are younger than 18 years of age and how they may be used in the congregation. Please discuss these points with each ministerial servant in your congregation who is younger than 18 years of age along with his parent or legal guardian.

- (1) Always respect parental headship when working with a young ministerial servant.
- (2) An elder should never be alone with a ministerial servant who is younger than 18 years of age. Use discernment to avoid any conduct that could be misinterpreted by others as morally questionable.—w17.05 p. 12 par. 19.
- (3) A ministerial servant who is younger than 18 years of age should not be given any responsibility that involves overseeing or supervising others. Use good judgment in providing assignments in keeping with the brother’s age and ability.

- (4) Some assignments that could be given to a ministerial servant who is younger than 18 years of age include assisting with the cleaning of the Kingdom Hall, carrying a microphone or working with sound equipment during congregation meetings, and assisting with literature or territory immediately before or after meetings at the Kingdom Hall.

FOR COORDINATORS OF THE BODIES OF ELDERS

9. Announcements for Congregations: Please ensure that the announcements for congregations are read at the next midweek meeting and thereafter posted on the information board for at least one month.

10. *How to Attack an Outline (emsv 01)*: Please inform the ministerial servants of the direction provided in [paragraph 3](#) of the announcements for elders.

11. Working Safely at Kingdom Halls: Please hold a brief meeting as soon as possible with all elders and ministerial servants to discuss the importance of safety. Assign a capable elder in your congregation, perhaps one serving as a Kingdom Hall Operating Committee member, to take the lead in conducting this meeting. At the meeting, he should review the information in the *Shepherd* book, chapter 21, paragraphs 27-32, emphasizing the principles on assigning work and the importance of quickly addressing any hazardous conditions. The video [Jehovah Wants You to Be Safe](#) may be played, or selected guidelines from *Working Together Safely—Standards for Theocratic Construction and Maintenance* (DC-82) may be considered.

FOR LIFE AND MINISTRY MEETING OVERSEERS

12. Midweek Meeting Part “Memorial Campaign to Begin Saturday, March 15”: Please ensure that the brother assigned to handle the midweek meeting part “Memorial Campaign to Begin Saturday, March 15,” scheduled for the week of March 10, 2025, encourages publishers to invite non-Witness family members, inactive family members, Bible students, return visits, and other acquaintances to the special talk and Memorial. He should also inform the congregation that during the campaign the jw.org home page will feature content related to the special talk and Memorial.

FOR SECRETARIES

13. Time and Location of Memorial Observance: Please update JW Hub with the time and location of your congregation’s Memorial observance if you have not already done so. If a group or pregroup hosted by your congregation will be holding a separate Memorial observance, the time and location for that Memorial should also be entered on JW Hub. Additionally, the recorded announcement on any phone answering system used for the Kingdom Hall should include the time and location of the Memorial observance(s).—*sfl* chap. 21 par. 35.

FOR FIELD SERVICE GROUP OVERSEERS IN AUSLAN AND NEW ZEALAND SIGN LANGUAGE CONGREGATIONS AND GROUPS

14. Revised *New World Translation* in Auslan: Please ensure that the publishers in your congregation or group are aware of the new release and assist them in accessing it as needed.

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FOR CONGREGATIONS

1. **2025 Special Talk and Memorial:** There will be a worldwide campaign to invite as many people as possible to attend the special talk and Memorial. The special talk for 2025 is entitled “Can Truth Be Found?” It will be presented on _____. The Memorial will be held on Saturday, April 12, 2025. No weekend meeting will be scheduled the week of the Memorial. Publishers may choose to auxiliary pioneer with a 15-hour requirement during the months of March and April.

2. **School for Kingdom Evangelizers Meeting at Conventions:** Starting with the 2025 conventions, the meeting for those interested in attending the School for Kingdom Evangelizers (SKE) will no longer be held. This change is being made in an effort to simplify convention arrangements, but it does not mean that we are reducing our focus on SKE. As emphasized at the 2024 annual meeting, the Governing Body is encouraging young pioneers who are at least 21 years of age to apply for the school. Since rapid growth is taking place in many lands, there is a need for more special pioneers, field missionaries, and circuit overseers. The school is designed to train pioneers who are willing to serve wherever they are needed. Those who are interested in attending the school should watch the video *Apply for the School for Kingdom Evangelizers!*, which has been made available on jw.org. If they would like more information, they should speak with the circuit overseer during his visit. Those who qualify may apply using the My Applications feature on JW Hub or request a printed application from the congregation secretary.

3. **Working Safely at Kingdom Halls:** Maintenance work at the Kingdom Hall should be performed under the direction of the elders and those assigned to oversee maintenance. This will ensure that there is proper planning and equipment so that the work can be performed safely.

FOR AUSLAN AND NEW ZEALAND SIGN LANGUAGE CONGREGATIONS AND GROUPS

4. **Revised *New World Translation* in Auslan:** As part of the incremental release of the revised *New World Translation of the Holy Scriptures* in Auslan, we are pleased to inform you that the book of Luke is now available in *JW Library Sign Language* and on jw.org and *Watchtower ONLINE LIBRARY*. Effective immediately, the new book may be used at congregation meetings and in the field ministry. We take this opportunity to thank you for your generous contributions to our worldwide Bible-educational work.

February 2025

PUBLICATIONS AND SUPPLIES AVAILABLE FOR REQUEST

1. The following item is now available. Please request the required quantities immediately.

Workbook for “Lessons You Can Learn From the Bible” 85427 English*

* This item has been designed to be used by all sign languages globally.

2. The following issues of periodicals will be newly produced.

Awake! No. 2 2018 Karen (S'gaw)
12 Secrets of Successful Families

The Watchtower (public edition) No. 1 2021 Urdu
Why Pray?

The Watchtower (public edition) No. 1 2025 Urdu
Tentative title: An End to War—How?

Coordinator of the body of elders: This notice may be posted on the congregation information board for at least one month and thereafter the literature servant should retain it in his file.